

Xiaochuan Li

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Computational cognitive science and language model interpretability. Current focus: epistemic modality.

EDUCATION

University of Technology Nuremberg <i>M.Sc. Human and Artificial Intelligence</i> Selected coursework: Cognitive Psychology; Foundations in Psychology & Empirical Study Design; Deep Learning; Interpretability for Natural Language Processing.	Nuremberg, Germany <i>Oct. 2025 – exp. 2027</i>
University of Marburg <i>Preparatory studies: German for graduate study</i>	Marburg, Germany <i>2024 – 2025</i>
Shenzhen University <i>B.A. Philosophy</i> Selected coursework: Logic; Mathematical Logic; Analytic Philosophy; Psychology of Reading; Cognition and Learning Disabilities.	Shenzhen, China <i>2020 – 2024</i>

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Epistemic modality in people and language models <i>Current focus · how modal expressions are understood and used, by people and by language models</i>	<i>2026 –</i>
FORMAL ANALYSIS	Three Ways of Leaving p Unsettled: compares <i>might p</i> , <i>might p or might not p</i> and <i>I don't know whether p</i> by the replies each licenses. <i>In development.</i>
HUMAN STUDY	M.Sc. thesis: modal language in preschool children, alongside a possibilities study at MPI CBS Leipzig; supervised by C. Grosse Wiesmann (UTN), with T. Hopf (MPI CBS). <i>In planning.</i>
COMPUTATIONAL MODEL	Modal choice: fits three competing accounts of the choice between <i>must</i> and <i>might</i> to published human data. <i>In development.</i>
Prompt framing and latent control states in language models <i>Year-long project course · with M. Roth (UTN) and S. Ostermann (DFKI)</i> Designed and ran the controlled experiments and causal interventions for the utilitarian-framing branch; manuscript in preparation.	<i>2026–27</i>
Typicality in referent choice: what the description leaves open <i>Independent theoretical study</i> Distinguishes three conditions for typicality in referent choice and the limits of what a forced-choice task can establish. Li, X. (2026). Working paper. lingbuzz/010343 · doi:10.5281/zenodo.22855036	<i>2026</i>
Cross-lingual ProtoBias <i>Single-author course project</i> Evaluation of two VLM families across seven prompt languages, about 12,600 judgments. report · code	<i>Summer 2026</i>

Street-view country classification

Summer 2026

Team course project, Deep Learning

My part: CNN training, ablations, and performance analysis.

Fact-checking after ChatGPT exposure

Winter 2025–26

Course study, Foundations in Psychology and Empirical Study Design

Between-subjects experiment (N = 49), group-designed and adopted for the class-wide study; my part: data analysis.

Leibniz’s logical system and characteristica universalis

2024

Undergraduate thesis · Shenzhen University · supervisor: Zang Yong

Analysed Leibniz’s metaphysics, logic and proposal for a universal symbolic language.

Learning difficulties in primary-school children

Sep.–Dec. 2021

Invited research project · Shenzhen Learning Disorders Association and Yucai No. 2 Primary School

Prepared character-reading materials and administered timed tests; analysed response data to identify learning difficulties and helped design teaching items and individual learning plans.

EMPLOYMENT

University of Technology Nuremberg

Nuremberg, Germany

IT Service Desk (part-time)

Apr. 2026 – present

Designed and delivered IT onboarding training for incoming students, with follow-up one-to-one support; also system installation, service reporting, and inventory.

SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

Programming	Python (PyTorch, Hugging Face Transformers, pandas, scikit-learn), Git, LaTeX
Methods	PsychoPy/Pavlovia, JASP; probing, activation patching, steering (working proficiency)
Languages	Mandarin Chinese (native), German (C1), English (C1), Japanese (learning)